

Operations

Question Booklet

Past HSC and trial questions from your Drive, screenshotted exactly as they appeared and sorted by syllabus dot point.

SECTION	QUESTIONS			
Section A — Multiple choice	Q1–18	18 questions	18 marks	p. 3
Section B — Short answer	Q19–45	27 questions	89 marks	p. 10
Section C — 20-mark questions	Q46–47	2 questions	40 marks	p. 27

How to use this booklet

1. **Section A** – multiple choice: circle one answer (about 1.5 min each).
2. **Section B** – short answers, grouped by the syllabus in the same order as your notes. Each question shows its source paper, marks and the dot point it tests. Write on the lines (about 1.8 min per mark).
3. **Section C** – the 20-mark questions are on the last pages: plan in the box, then write in full on separate paper.
4. Check every answer in the matching **Answer Booklet** – question numbers are identical.
5. Tick off the **Syllabus map** (next page) as you master each dot point.

Syllabus map

Every dot point in the syllabus (as in your notes) and the questions in this booklet that test it. Tick each one off once you can answer its questions confidently.

CODE	SYLLABUS DOT POINT	QUESTIONS	✓
O1a	Strategic role of operations management – cost leadership, good/service differentiation	Q1, Q19, Q45	☐
O1b	Goods and/or services in different industries	Q2	☐
O1c	Interdependence (operations) with other key business functions	Q10, Q20	☐
O2a	Influences: globalisation, technology, quality expectations, cost-based competition, government policies, legal regulation, environmental sustainability	Q3, Q21, Q22, Q23, Q46	☐
O2b	Corporate social responsibility – legal compliance vs ethical responsibility; environmental sustainability and social responsibility	Q3, Q4, Q23, Q24, Q25, Q34	☐
O3a	Inputs – transformed resources (materials, information, customers); transforming resources (human resources, facilities)	Q5, Q26, Q27	☐
O3b	Transformation processes – influence of volume, variety, variation in demand, visibility (4 Vs)	Q6, Q28, Q29	☐
O3c	Sequencing and scheduling – Gantt charts, critical path analysis	Q7, Q8, Q30, Q31	☐
O3d	Technology, task design and process layout	Q32, Q33, Q40	☐
O3e	Monitoring, control and improvement	Q9, Q31	☐
O3f	Outputs – customer service, warranties	Q10, Q34	☐
O4a	Performance objectives – quality, speed, dependability, flexibility, customisation, cost	Q11, Q35, Q36, Q40, Q47	☐
O4b	New product or service design and development	Q37	☐
O4c	Supply chain management – logistics, e-commerce, global sourcing	Q12, Q21, Q38, Q44, Q47	☐
O4d	Outsourcing – advantages and disadvantages	Q13, Q39	☐
O4e	Technology – leading edge, established	Q14, Q21, Q40, Q43, Q47	☐
O4f	Inventory management – advantages/disadvantages of holding stock, LIFO, FIFO, JIT	Q15, Q16, Q41, Q42	☐
O4g	Quality management – control, assurance, improvement	Q10, Q17, Q39, Q44, Q47	☐
O4h	Overcoming resistance to change – financial costs, purchasing new equipment, redundancy payments, retraining, reorganising plant layout, inertia	Q43, Q46	☐
O4i	Global factors – global sourcing, economies of scale, scanning and learning, research and development	Q12, Q18, Q38, Q44, Q45	☐

Section A — Multiple choice

Circle the best answer. About 1.5 minutes each.

Q1 2019 HSC · Q11 O1a · Strategic role of operations

- 11 A sole-trader cleaning business purchases generic products to lower costs and be price competitive.

This is an example of which strategy?

- A. Cost leadership
- B. Economies of scale
- C. Inventory management
- D. Goods and service differentiation

Q2 Roseville Trial 2023 · Q8 O1b · Goods & services

- 8 Goods and services have different characteristics and features.

Which of the following combinations of attributes is correct?

	<i>Goods</i>	<i>Services</i>
(A)	Tangible	Intangible
(B)	Have physical inputs	Need be stored in a warehouse
(C)	Often stored in warehouses	Tangible
(D)	Intangible	Perishable

Q3 2022 HSC · Q10 O2a · Operations influences O2b · CSR

- 10 A printing business uses chemicals in its production process.

Which of the following factors has a legal regulation that affects the operations management of this business?

- A. Superannuation
- B. Code of conduct
- C. Union membership
- D. Environmental protection

Q4**2021 HSC · Q12****O2b · CSR**

- 12 A manager at a fast-food business wants to change the operations process in response to the influence of corporate social responsibility.

Which action would achieve this objective?

- A. Providing cash donations to a local hospital
 - B. Increasing the visibility of the cooking process
 - C. Offering a wider variety of healthy options on their menu
 - D. Ensuring that injured workers receive access to compensation payments
-

Q5**Newington Trial 2023 · Q5****O3a · Inputs**

5. Which of the following are both transformed resources for a fast-food restaurant?

- A. Grill and cash register
 - B. Cook and cooking utensils
 - C. Tables and chairs
 - D. Hamburgers and soft drink
-

Q6**Roseville Trial 2024 · Q9****O3b · 4 Vs**

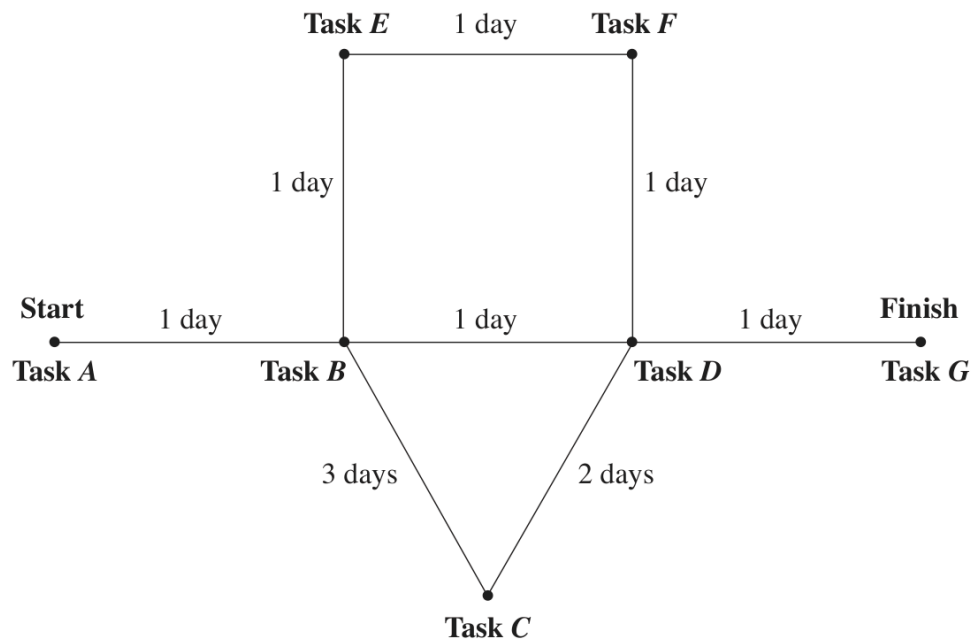
- 9 A bakery produces a range of baked goods, including bread, cakes, and pastries. They have a visible production area where customers can watch the baking process, which is a key part of their operations strategy.

Which of the following best describes the visibility aspect of the 4 Vs of operations in this bakery?

Visibility refers to the:

- (A) large quantities of bread produced daily.
 - (B) seasonal demand changes for different baked goods.
 - (C) different types of baked goods offered, such as bread, cakes, and pastries.
 - (D) fact that customers can directly observe the baking process.
-

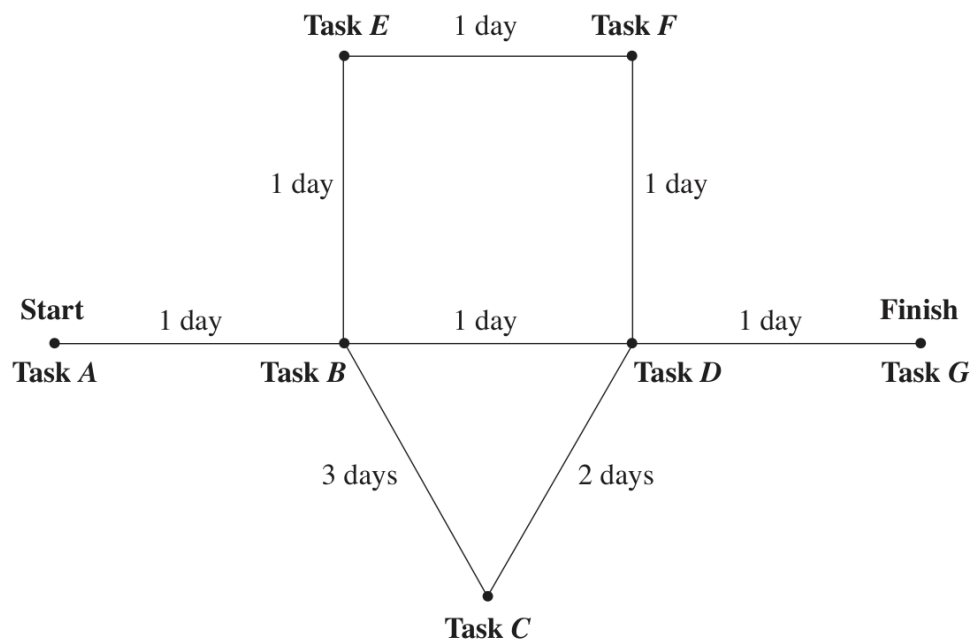
Use the following critical path diagram to answer Questions 19 and 20.



19 Which tasks need to be completed prior to completing Task *D*?

- A. *A, B* only
- B. *A, B, C* only
- C. *A, B, E, F* only
- D. *A, B, C, E, F* only

Use the following critical path diagram to answer Questions 19 and 20.



- 20 An improvement in technology reduces the time between Task C and Task D to one day.

What is the new length of the critical path?

- A. 3 days
- B. 5 days
- C. 6 days
- D. 10 days

9. After comparing monthly data on defects, an operations manager makes changes to the production line to improve efficiency and dependability.

Which operations process is being implemented by the manager?

- a) Sequencing and scheduling
- b) Monitoring
- c) Controlling
- d) Critical Path Analysis

Q10**2021 HSC · Q14**

O3f · Outputs

O4g · Quality management

O1c · Interdependence

- 14 A car manufacturer's marketing manager suggests to the operations manager that they increase the warranty period from 3 to 5 years in order to increase market share.

The operations manager would agree to this suggestion if

- A. gearing has reduced.
 - B. it provided an incentive to increase production speed.
 - C. current quality management strategies could support it.
 - D. it provided sales staff the opportunity to increase sales commissions.
-

Q11**2023 HSC · Q2**

O4a · Performance objectives

- 2 A florist designs floral displays for weddings to suit the colour preferences of individual couples.

Which of the following would be the main performance objective being targeted by this florist?

- A. Customisation
 - B. Flexibility
 - C. Quality
 - D. Speed
-

Q12**2022 HSC · Q7**

O4c · Supply chain management

O4i · Global factors

- 7 A large clothing manufacturer in NSW wants to reduce input costs.

Which strategy would achieve this objective?

- A. Increasing product variety
 - B. Increasing employee training
 - C. Implementing global sourcing
 - D. Implementing sustainable packaging
-

13. Which of the following are both an advantage and disadvantage of a business outsourcing an operations function?

	<i>Advantage</i>	<i>Disadvantage</i>
a)	Access to skilled labour and resources not attained by the business	Decreased costs of production
b)	Increased vulnerability to the external business environment	Economies of scale
c)	Loss of control of the production process	Increased costs of production
d)	Efficiency and cost savings	Communication and language barriers

3 Which row of the table shows both an advantage and a disadvantage of a business investing in leading edge technology?

	<i>Advantage</i>	<i>Disadvantage</i>
A.	Higher quality output	High initial investment
B.	Proven effectiveness	Increased waste
C.	Widely accepted and used	High initial investment
D.	Increased speed	Increased waste

5. *Henry Electronics Pty Ltd* has a stock valuation policy which records the business's newest stock as the first stock sold.

Which of the following is the inventory management strategy implemented by the business?

- a) LIFO
- b) JIT
- c) Value Added
- d) FIFO

Q16**Knox Trial 2023 · Q17****O4f · Inventory management**

17 What is the impact of moving to a just-in-time (JIT) inventory management system?

	Holding costs	Logistics costs	Risk of stock outage
A.	Lower	Higher	Higher
B.	Same	Higher	Lower
C.	Higher	Lower	Same
D.	Lower	Lower	Lower

Q17**2019 HSC · Q9****O4g · Quality management**

9 A business reduces product defects by using inspections in the production process.

This is an example of quality

- A. control.
- B. improvement.
- C. innovation.
- D. production.

Q18**2020 HSC · Q13****O4i · Global factors**

13 In order to achieve best practice, a mobile phone company examines global trends in phone technology before designing and producing their phones.

What operations strategy is this business using?

- A. Standardisation
- B. Global sourcing
- C. Scanning and learning
- D. Inventory management

Section B — Short answer

Grouped by the four parts of the Operations syllabus. Aim for about 1.8 minutes per mark.

1. Role of operations management

O1a Strategic role of operations management – cost leadership, good/service differentiation

Q19 2020 HSC · Question 23 (a) O1a · Strategic role of operations

4 marks

A denim jeans clothing store is concerned about declining sales. They have identified that the lower sales are a result of:

- outdated store presentation
- increased foreign competition
- a reluctance to adopt modern in-store payment methods.

(a) How could the strategic role of operations management assist this business? 4

Precision Shave produces and sells a collection of eco-friendly razors made from sustainable materials. The business is also introducing a subscription service that delivers customised shaving kits catering to the specific needs of individual consumers.

b) Explain the interdependence of operations and marketing for this business.

(3 marks)

2. Influences on operations management

O2a Influences: globalisation, technology, quality expectations, cost-based competition, government policies, legal regulation, environmental sustainability

Q21 2020 HSC · Question 23 (b)

O2a · Operations influences

O4e · Technology

O4c · Supply chain management

6 marks

A denim jeans clothing store is concerned about declining sales. They have identified that the lower sales are a result of:

- outdated store presentation
- increased foreign competition
- a reluctance to adopt modern in-store payment methods.

- outdated store presentation
- increased foreign competition
- a reluctance to adopt modern in-store payment methods.

(b) Analyse operations strategies that could be used to address TWO operations influences affecting this business.

6

This image shows a single sheet of white paper with horizontal blue ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the paper.

Use the following information to answer the questions below.

Rebecca owns and operates a health food business. Due to an increase in competition from large retail chains, she needs to revise her operational strategies. A problem that her customers have identified is products that are consistently 'out of stock', as well as damaged goods in need of replacing.

- (c) Outline how quality expectations could impact this business

2

- (b) A market leading business manufactures electronics.

4

Explain how environmental sustainability can influence the operations of this business.

Q24 Barker Trial 2024 · Question 22 (a) O2b · CSR

2 marks

- (a) Distinguish between legal compliance and corporate social responsibility.

2

Q25 2019 HSC · Question 24 (c) O2b · CSR

4 marks

A juice bar is operating in a shopping centre. The juice is served to customers in plastic cups with plastic straws. The high sales volume and quick turnover demand an efficient operations process.

- (c) Why might this business be reluctant to become more socially responsible?

4

3. Operations processes

O3a Inputs – transformed resources (materials, information, customers); transforming resources (human resources, facilities)

Q26 2019 HSC · Question 24 (a) **O3a · Inputs**

2 marks

A juice bar is operating in a shopping centre. The juice is served to customers in plastic cups with plastic straws. The high sales volume and quick turnover demand an efficient operations process.

- (a) Identify TWO transforming resources used in this business. **2**

Q27 2021 HSC · Question 21 (a) **O3a · Inputs**

2 marks

A building company has been contracted to build a new home for a customer. The contract requires the home to be completed within six months and within budget.

- (a) Outline how this customer can be considered an input in the construction of the new home. **2**

Q28 2019 HSC · Question 24 (b)

O3b · 4 Vs

4 marks

A juice bar is operating in a shopping centre. The juice is served to customers in plastic cups with plastic straws. The high sales volume and quick turnover demand an efficient operations process.

(b) How does variety impact the transformation process of this business?

4

Q29 Reddam Trial 2023 · Question 21 (d)

O3b · 4 Vs

4 marks

A car retailer expects high demand and orders extra stock of the latest release lower priced, electric car. The car retailer also provides longer warranties than competitors as well as car repairs and services.

(d) Discuss the impact of variety and visibility on the transformation process of the car retailer.

4

Q30 2021 HSC · Question 21 (b) O3c · Sequencing & scheduling

4 marks

A building company has been contracted to build a new home for a customer. The contract requires the home to be completed within six months and within budget.

- (b) How could a Gantt chart help the building company meet the terms of the contract? **4**

Q31 Operations Exam Prep · Question 23 (c) O3c · Sequencing & scheduling O3e · Monitoring, control & improvement

4 marks

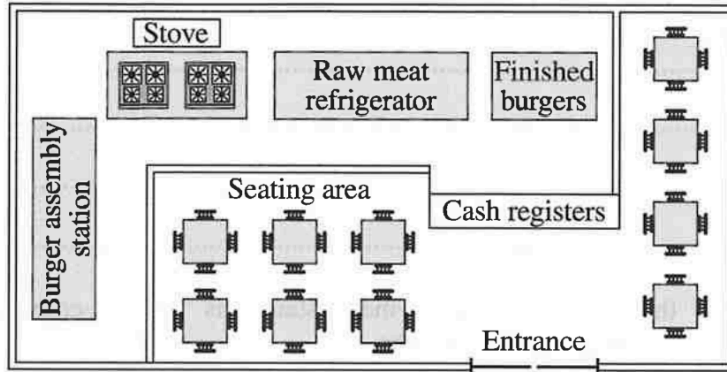
- (c) Explain how Gantt charts and critical path analysis can be used to improve business operations. **4**

Michael would like to open a new burger restaurant.

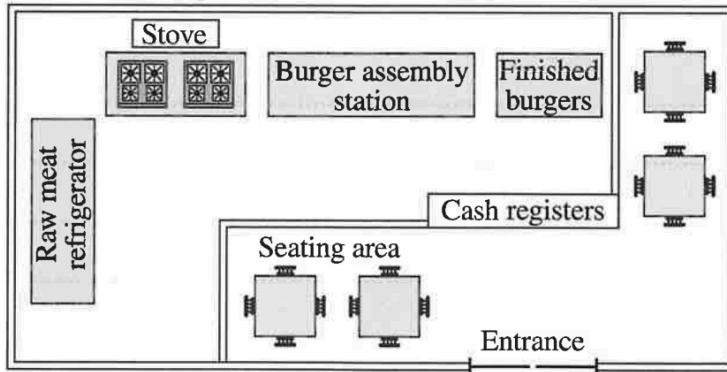
- (c) Michael is considering which process layout would be the most efficient for this restaurant.

4

Process layout option 1



Process layout option 2



Compare each layout in terms of efficiency and profitability.

Q33**Barker Trial 2023 · Question 21 (c)**

O3d · Tech, task design & layout

2 marks

- (c) Outline the purpose of task design.

2

O3f Outputs – customer service, warranties**Q34****Reddam Trial 2023 · Question 21 (c)**

O3f · Outputs

O2b · CSR

2 marks

A car retailer expects high demand and orders extra stock of the latest release lower priced, electric car. The car retailer also provides longer warranties than competitors as well as car repairs and services.

- (c) Why may this business exceed its legal obligations when offering warranties to customers?

2

4. Operations strategies

O4a Performance objectives – quality, speed, dependability, flexibility, customisation, cost

Q 35 2022 HSC · Question 21 (a) **O4a · Performance objectives**

2 marks

Michael would like to open a new burger restaurant.

(a) Outline a performance objective relevant to this business.

2

Q 36 Reddam Trial 2024 · Question 21 (b) **O4a · Performance objectives**

2 marks

A leading sports shoe manufacturer enables customers to design their own shoes. This has required the business to purchase an additional factory and machinery.

(b) Explain ONE possible conflict that may arise between achieving TWO performance objectives for the sports shoe manufacturer.

2

O4b New product or service design and development

Q37 Newington Trial 2023 · Question 23 (b)

O4b · New product design

4 marks

- (b) A business has decided to expand its product range. Discuss the operational strategy of new product or service design and development for this business **4**

O4i Global factors – global sourcing, economies of scale, scanning and learning, research and development

Q38 Roseville Trial 2024 · Question 21 (d)

O4i · Global factors

O4c · Supply chain management

4 marks

Sushi Train is a successful global Japanese fast food company that has been rapidly expanding in Australia. Customers have been attracted to their unique process layout, which sees little plates of sushi rotate around via a train style system. Customers take their meals directly from the train and get to watch their meals produced in front of their eyes.

- (d) Explain how the operations strategies of global sourcing and economies of scale might be beneficial to this business. **4**

Q39 2021 HSC · Question 21 (c)

O4g · Quality management

O4d · Outsourcing

4 marks

A building company has been contracted to build a new home for a customer. The contract requires the home to be completed within six months and within budget.

The operations manager will need to outsource certain elements of the construction process.

- (c) Explain TWO quality management strategies that could be used to ensure the quality of the outsourced work. **4**

Use the following information to answer questions 22 (b) and (c).

Focus Frames produces eyewear such as sunglasses and prescription glasses using an automated assembly line that is run by a combination of staff and robotics.

They are seeking to improve the speed and efficiency of their manufacturing process.

- (c) Analyse the implementation of technology in achieving operations objectives for this business.

5

Q41 2022 HSC · Question 21 (b) O4f · Inventory management

3 marks

Michael would like to open a new burger restaurant.

- (b) Recommend an appropriate inventory management strategy for this business. **3**

Q42 Reddam Trial 2023 · Question 21 (b) O4f · Inventory management

2 marks

A car retailer expects high demand and orders extra stock of the latest release lower priced, electric car. The car retailer also provides longer warranties than competitors as well as car repairs and services.

- (b) Describe ONE disadvantage of holding stock for the car retailer. **2**

Q43 2023 HSC · Question 21 (c)

O4h · Resistance to change

O4e · Technology

5 marks

An Australian tyre manufacturer is expanding its business. In order to reduce operating costs and increase sales and profit, rubber will be sourced from the global market.

The business wants to:

- maintain quality outputs
- achieve economies of scale.

- (c) The owners of the tyre manufacturing business have purchased leading-edge technology to help achieve economies of scale. **5**

Explain why both staff and management might be resistant to this change.

Q44 2023 HSC · Question 21 (a)

O4i · Global factors

O4c · Supply chain management

O4g · Quality management

2 marks

An Australian tyre manufacturer is expanding its business. In order to reduce operating costs and increase sales and profit, rubber will be sourced from the global market.

The business wants to:

- maintain quality outputs
- achieve economies of scale.

- (a) Outline ONE potential issue this business could face in relation to both cost and quality of outputs. **2**

Q45 2023 HSC · Question 21 (b)

O4i · Global factors

O1a · Strategic role of operations

3 marks

An Australian tyre manufacturer is expanding its business. In order to reduce operating costs and increase sales and profit, rubber will be sourced from the global market.

The business wants to:

- maintain quality outputs
- achieve economies of scale.

- (b) Explain the benefits of achieving economies of scale for both the business and consumers. **3**

Section C — 20-mark questions

A business report and an essay. Plan in the box, then write on separate paper (about 35 minutes each).

Q46 2021 HSC · Question 25

O2a · Operations influences

O4h · Resistance to change

F2b · External finance

20 marks

Ozzi Baby Food Pty Ltd have developed a trusted reputation in domestic and global markets due to their safe and sustainably-sourced product range. This has led to a significant increase in demand. As a result, they are considering the purchase of a larger automated factory. This will lead to some job losses. The business will require external finance to fund the factory purchase using either a mortgage or becoming a public company on the Australian Securities Exchange (ASX).

You have been hired as a consultant by Ozzi Baby Food Pty Ltd to write a business report to the owners. In your report:

- outline TWO operations influences affecting this business
- discuss the use of retraining and redundancy payments to help overcome employee resistance to these changes
- compare the use of a mortgage to a new issue of shares to fund the factory purchase.

PLAN

Thesis / judgement

Body 1

Body 2

Body 3

Case study evidence

Conclusion

Write your full response on separate paper — about 35 minutes / 4 pages.

Analyse the relationship between performance objectives and operations strategies.

PLAN

Thesis / judgement

Body 1

Body 2

Body 3

Case study evidence

Conclusion

Write your full response on separate paper — about 35 minutes / 4 pages.